AN UGLY PREJUDICE

THE 'DARK VERSUS FAIR' DEBATE REIGNITES, EXPOSING THE PERSISTENT BIAS AGAINST DARKER SKIN AMONG INDIANS

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Illustration by NILANJAN DAS / AI

COLOUR OF DISCRIMINATION

***Sarada Muraleedharan,** who succeeded her husband V. Venu as the Chief Secretary of Kerala, recently found herself at the receiving end of a sexist, colourist remark, provoking her to take to Facebook to call out the injustice. Excerpts from her post...*

"Heard an interesting comment yesterday on my stewardship as chief secretary – that it is as black as my husband's was white. Hmmm. I need to own my blackness"

"Why did I want to call this particular one out? It was about being labelled black (with that quiet subtext of being woman)"

"Why should black be vilified? Black is the all-pervasive truth of the universe. Black is that which can absorb anything, the most powerful pulse of energy known to humankind. It is the colour that works on everyone, the dress code for office, the lustre of evening wear, the essence of kajol, the promise of rain"



H RAJENDRAN

"As a four year old I apparently asked my mother whether she could put me back in her womb and bring me out again, all white and pretty"